

ANTI DEFECTION LAW

FROM 1967 INSTABILITY TO → GROUNDS AND MEMBER-TYPE RULES → POLITICAL PARTY, LEGISLATURE PARTY → MERGER, DELETED SPLIT AND → PRESIDING-OFFICER PROCESS, NATURAL JUSTICE → RESIGNATION, DISQUALIFICATION AND THE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 FROM 1967 INSTABILITY TO THE 52ND AND 91ST AMENDMENT DESIGN

FROM 1967 INSTABILITY TO THE 52ND AND 91ST AMENDMENT

ROOT QUESTION

HOW CAN PARTY-GOVERNMENT STABILITY BE PROTECTED WITHOUT EXTINGUISHING LEGISLATIVE

1967 DEFECTIONS

COMMITTEE ON DEFECTIONS

52ND AMENDMENT ACT 1985.

TENTH SCHEDULE EFFECTIVE 1 MARCH 1985.

52ND AMENDMENT

ROOT QUESTION

How can party-government stability be protected without extinguishing legislative judgment?

1967 defections → Committee on Defections → 52nd Amendment Act 1985.

Tenth Schedule effective 1 March 1985.

52ND AMENDMENT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How can party-government stability be protected without extinguishing legislative judgment?
- 1967 defections → Committee on Defections → 52nd Amendment Act 1985.
- Tenth Schedule effective 1 March 1985.
- 52ND AMENDMENT

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Articles 101, 102, 190, 191 + Tenth Schedule.
- 91ST AMENDMENT split defence deleted
- ministry-size caps
- Articles 75(1B), 164(1B), 361B office disabilities.
- CURRENT PARAGRAPH MAP

CHECK / LIMIT

- 1 definitions
- 2 grounds
- 3 omitted
- 4 merger
- 5 presiding exemption

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 6 decision
- 7 invalid court bar
- 8 rules.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 'Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram' episode symbolises how frequent defections destabilised governments and created the political demand for constitutional regulation.

01

STAGE 01 GROUNDS AND MEMBER-TYPE RULES

GROUNDS AND MEMBER-TYPE RULES

PARTY MEMBER VOLUNTARILY GIVES UP MEMBERSHIP

OR VOTES/ABSTAINS CONTRARY TO DIRECTION WITHOUT PRIOR PERMISSION, UNLESS

INDEPENDENT MEMBER JOINING A POLITICAL PARTY AFTER ELECTION

NO SIX-MONTH WINDOW.

NOMINATED MEMBER MAY JOIN WITHIN SIX MONTHS FROM TAKING

JOINING AFTER THAT PERIOD

RAVI S. NAIK (1994) VOLUNTARILY GIVING UP IS WIDER

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

PARTY MEMBER voluntarily gives up membership

OR votes/abstains contrary to direction without prior permission, unless condoned within fifteen days.

POWER / PROCEDURE

INDEPENDENT MEMBER joining a political party after election → disqualification.

No six-month window.

CHECK / LIMIT

NOMINATED MEMBER may join within six months from taking the seat

joining after that period → disqualification.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Ravi S. Naik (1994) voluntarily giving up is wider than formal resignation and may be inferred from conduct.

TRAP dissenting speech alone is not automatically paragraph 2(1)(b) voting conduct.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

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- OR votes/abstains contrary to direction without prior permission, unless condoned within fifteen days.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- INDEPENDENT MEMBER joining a political party after election → disqualification.
- No six-month window.

CHECK / LIMIT

- NOMINATED MEMBER may join within six months from taking the seat
- joining after that period → disqualification.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Ravi S. Naik (1994) voluntarily giving up is wider than formal resignation and may be inferred from conduct.
- TRAP dissenting speech alone is not automatically paragraph 2(1)(b) voting conduct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Voluntarily giving up party membership extends beyond formal resignation and may be inferred from conduct, but isolated disagreement should not mechanically establish defection.

02

STAGE 02 POLITICAL PARTY, LEGISLATURE PARTY AND THE EXACT WHIP TEST

POLITICAL PARTY, LEGISLATURE PARTY AND THE EXACT WHIP TEST

ORIGINAL POLITICAL PARTY PARTY TO WHICH THE MEMBER BELONGS

LEGISLATURE PARTY

HOUSE MEMBERS BELONGING TO THE SAME POLITICAL PARTY.

WHIP TEST AUTHORISED PARTY DIRECTION

VOTE OR ABSTENTION

NO PRIOR PERMISSION

NO CONDONATION WITHIN FIFTEEN DAYS.

ORIGINAL POLITICAL PARTY party to which the member belongs for Schedule purposes.

LEGISLATURE PARTY

House members belonging to the same political party.

WHIP TEST authorised party direction → vote or abstention

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ORIGINAL POLITICAL PARTY party to which the member belongs for Schedule purposes.
- LEGISLATURE PARTY

POWER / PROCEDURE

- House members belonging to the same political party.
- WHIP TEST authorised party direction → vote or abstention

CHECK / LIMIT

- no prior permission → no condonation within fifteen days.
- Subhash Desai (2023) the political party, not a legislature-party faction acting alone, authorises the whip/leader for Tenth Schedule purposes.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CURRENT LAW direction may reach ordinary votes under the text.
- PROPOSAL restrict whips to confidence, no-confidence, Money Bills or core manifesto matters.

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• No six-month window.

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Tenth Schedule distinguishes the political party, legislature party and member's original political party, preventing organisational affiliation from being collapsed into the House group.

03

STAGE 03 MERGER, DELETED SPLIT AND THE NARROW PRESIDING-OFFICER EXEMPTION

MERGER, DELETED SPLIT AND THE NARROW PRESIDING-OFFICER EXEMPTION

PARAGRAPH 3 ONE-THIRD SPLIT DEFENCE OMITTED BY THE 91ST

PARAGRAPH 4 ORIGINAL POLITICAL PARTY MERGER + NOT LESS

PROTECTED CHOICE TO JOIN MERGER OR OPERATE AS SEPARATE

INTERPRETIVE CAUTION TWO-THIRDS LEGISLATORS CANNOT BE WRITTEN AS A

ORIGINAL-PARTY AND DEEMING PROVISIONS REMAIN CENTRAL AND LIVE DISPUTES

PARAGRAPH 5 NARROW EXEMPTION FOR SPECIFIED PRESIDING OFFICERS ON

SPEAKER NEUTRALITY ASPIRATION DOES NOT CREATE A GENERAL EXEMPTION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PARAGRAPH 3 one-third split defence omitted by the 91st Amendment.
- PARAGRAPH 4 original political party merger + not less than two-thirds of legislature party agree

POWER / PROCEDURE

- protected choice to join merger or operate as separate group under the text.
- INTERPRETIVE CAUTION two-thirds legislators cannot be written as a free-standing permission to switch parties

CHECK / LIMIT

- original-party and deeming provisions remain central and live disputes must be qualified.
- PARAGRAPH 5 narrow exemption for specified presiding officers on giving up/rejoining party subject to exact office and timing conditions.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Speaker neutrality aspiration does not create a general exemption for every office-holder.
- PARAGRAPH 3 one-third split defence omitted by the 91st Amendment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Paragraph 5 protects only specified presiding officers under stated conditions, not ministers, whips or committee chairs generally.

04

STAGE 04 PRESIDING-OFFICER PROCESS, NATURAL JUSTICE AND JUDICIAL REVIEW

PRESIDING-OFFICER PROCESS, NATURAL JUSTICE AND JUDICIAL REVIEW

FIRST INSTANCE

SPEAKER/CHAIRMAN DECIDES; IF THAT OFFICER IS CONCERNED, HOUSE ELECTS

PROCESS PETITION

REASONED DECISION

SEAT CONSEQUENCE.

KIHOTO HOLLOHAN (1992) PRESIDING OFFICER ACTS AS TRIBUNAL; PARAGRAPH

LIMITED JUDICIAL REVIEW SURVIVES FOR JURISDICTIONAL ERROR, MALA FIDES

FIRST INSTANCE

Speaker/Chairman decides; if that officer is concerned, House elects another member.

PROCESS petition → maintainability/facts → notice → reply/evidence → hearing

reasoned decision → seat consequence.

Kihoto Hollohan (1992) presiding officer acts as tribunal; paragraph 7 invalid for lack of ratification

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FIRST INSTANCE
- Speaker/Chairman decides; if that officer is concerned, House elects another member.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PROCESS petition → maintainability/facts → notice → reply/evidence → hearing
- reasoned decision → seat consequence.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Kihoto Hollohan (1992) presiding officer acts as tribunal; paragraph 7 invalid for lack of ratification
- limited judicial review survives for jurisdictional error, mala fides and natural justice.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Keisham Meghachandra Singh (2020) absent exceptional circumstances, petitions should ordinarily be decided within three months.
- LIMIT courts ordinarily do not replace the Speaker as first-instance fact finder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The current Tenth Schedule retains disqualification, merger, decision and rule-making provisions, while the former one-third split defence remains omitted.

05

STAGE 05 RESIGNATION, DISQUALIFICATION AND THE 91ST-AMENDMENT OFFICE BARS

RESIGNATION, DISQUALIFICATION AND THE 91ST-AMENDMENT OFFICE BARS

CHRONOLOGY ALLEGED DEFECTION

SPEAKER DECISIONS

JUDICIAL REVIEW.

SHRIMANTH BALASAHEB PATIL (2019) RESIGNATION DOES NOT ERASE ANTECEDENT

SPEAKER CANNOT ADD AN EXTRA RE-ELECTION BAN BEYOND CONSTITUTIONAL

DIRECT EFFECT LOSS OF HOUSE MEMBERSHIP UNDER ARTICLES 102(2)/191(2).

OFFICE DISABILITIES

CHRONOLOGY alleged defection → petition → resignation → Speaker decisions → judicial review.

Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil (2019) resignation does not erase antecedent disqualification

Speaker cannot add an extra re-election ban beyond constitutional text.

DIRECT EFFECT loss of House membership under Articles 102(2)/191(2).

OFFICE DISABILITIES

LIMITED JUDICIAL REVIEW SURVIVES FOR JURISDICTIONAL ERROR, MALA FIDES



- ## POWER / PROCEDURE

- CHECK / LIMIT

- ### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** The current Tenth Schedule retains disqualification, merger, decision and rule-making provisions, while the former one-third split defence remains omitted.

STAGE 05 RESIGNATION, DISQUALIFICATION AND THE 91ST-AMENDMENT OFFICE BARS



- ### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ## POWER / PROCEDURE

- CHECK / LIMIT

- ## FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Articles 75(1B) and 164(1B) prevent specified defectors from gaining ministerial reward until the original term ends or they are earlier re-elected.

STAGE 06 NABAM REBIA (2016), SUBHASH DESAI (2023) AND DISTRIBUTED INSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY



- CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE**

- POWER / PROCEDURE

- CHECK / LIMIT

- FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- MECHANISM / VERDICT** — Subhash Desai (2023) referred correctness of that rule to a seven-judge bench.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nabam Rebia (2016) held that a Speaker should not adjudicate disqualification petitions while a notice of intention to move a resolution for the Speaker's removal is pending.

STAGE 07 DEMOCRATIC BALANCE, COMPARISON AND REFORM CHOICES



RPA → statutory grounds/procedure

REFORM OPTIONS narrow whip

protects mandate

privilege → House discipline symbol dispute → ECI field.

independent tribunal/ECI-advice model

supports government stability.

[illegible]

statutory time limit reasoned public procedure

- ### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- GAINS reduces open floor-crossing

- ## POWER / PROCEDURE

- strategic delay merger engineering

- CHECK / LIMIT

- RPA → statutory grounds/procedure

- ### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- neutral presiding-office safeguards.

Speaker taking a pending removal notice was held disabled from deciding defection petitions.

- PENDING QUALIFICATION
- Subhash Desai (2023) referred correctness of that rule to a seven-judge bench.

Subhash Desai (2023) political party authorises whip

- Speaker determines party identity for Schedule purpose
- ECI symbol proceeding is separate

DISTRIBUTED ROLES

- Speaker → defection
- ECI → symbol/order field

COURT REVIEW.

- TRAP floor test, symbol dispute and defection petition answer different legal questions.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Subhash Desai (2023) referred correctness of that rule to a seven-judge bench.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nabam Rebia (2016) held that a Speaker should not adjudicate disqualification petitions while a notice of intention to move a resolution for the Speaker's removal is pending.

07

STAGE 07

DEMOCRATIC BALANCE, COMPARISON AND REFORM CHOICES

DEMOCRATIC BALANCE, COMPARISON AND REFORM CHOICES

GAINS REDUCES OPEN FLOOR-CROSSING

PROTECTS MANDATE

SUPPORTS GOVERNMENT STABILITY.

COSTS BROAD WHIP SUPPRESSES DELIBERATION

SPEAKER INCENTIVES

STRATEGIC DELAY MERGER ENGINEERING

RESIGNATION TACTICS

GAINS reduces open floor-crossing	protects mandate	supports government stability.	
RPA → statutory grounds/procedure	privilege → House discipline symbol dispute → ECI field.		
REFORM OPTIONS narrow whip	independent tribunal/ECI-advice model	statutory time limit reasoned public procedure	neutral presiding-office safeguards.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- GAINS reduces open floor-crossing
- protects mandate
- supports government stability.
- COSTS broad whip suppresses deliberation
- Speaker incentives

POWER / PROCEDURE

- strategic delay merger engineering
- resignation tactics
- weakened committee scrutiny.
- Tenth Schedule → Speaker/Chairman.
- Articles 102(1)/191(1) post-election question → President/Governor on ECI opinion.

CHECK / LIMIT

- RPA → statutory grounds/procedure
- privilege → House discipline symbol dispute → ECI field.
- REFORM OPTIONS narrow whip
- independent tribunal/ECI-advice model
- statutory time limit reasoned public procedure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- neutral presiding-office safeguards.
- STATUS these are proposals unless enacted or judicially ordered in a particular case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Tenth Schedule disputes concern continued House membership, unlike other disqualifications, symbol disputes or election petitions, which follow separate authorities and procedures.

08

STAGE 08

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQS AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQS AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALL

52ND CREATED

91ST TIGHTENED

SPLIT DELETED

MERGER TWO-THIRDS GIVING UP WIDER THAN RESIGNATION

INDEPENDENT NO WINDOW NOMINATED SIX MONTHS

CONDONATION FIFTEEN DAYS

PRELIMS FIREWALL

52nd created

91st tightened

split deleted

merger two-thirds giving up wider than resignation

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- PRELIMS FIREWALL 52nd created 91st tightened - split deleted - merger two-thirds giving up wider than resignation	- independent no window nominated six months - condonation fifteen days - Speaker first - judicial review survives - defection not crime.	- VERIFIED ROUTES 2022 Prelims → nominated members. 2025 Prelims → political-party and Tenth Schedule distinction. 2023 GS-II supporting route → presiding-officer impartiality. - MAINS SPINE history → grounds/member types → party/whip	- merger → process/review/delay → resignation/office bars - institutional conflicts → stability-freedom balance → bounded reform. - VERDICT stability needs discipline, but democratic legitimacy needs a narrower whip, neutral adjudication and enforceable decision time.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The nominated member may join within the first six months without this disqualification.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

PART A — ORIGIN

PART B — GROUNDS OF DISQUALIFICATION

PART C — DECIDING AUTHORITY & JUDICIAL REVIEW

PART D — 91ST AMENDMENT ACT, 2003

52ND AMENDMENT ACT, 1985 ADDED THE TENTH SCHEDULE (AMENDING

91ST AMENDMENT ACT, 2003 DELETED THE "SPLIT" EXCEPTION (WHICH

MERGER — IF AT LEAST 2/3 OF THE LEGISLATURE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- PART A — ORIGIN
- PART B — GROUNDS OF DISQUALIFICATION
- PART C — DECIDING AUTHORITY & JUDICIAL REVIEW
- PART D — 91st AMENDMENT ACT, 2003

ADVANCED LIMIT

- 52nd Amendment Act, 1985 added the Tenth Schedule (amending Arts 101, 102, 190, 191) — the
- 91st Amendment Act, 2003 deleted the "split" exception (which had protected 1/3-strength splits).
- Merger — if at least 2/3 of the legislature party agree to the merger;
- Presiding officer who gives up party membership on taking office (dignity of the chair).

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- NOT: The "split" exception (1/3 members) was REMOVED by the 91st Amendment (2003) — so only merger remains.
- Decided by the Presiding Officer (Speaker/Chairman) of the House.
- Kihoto Hollohan (1992) v. Zachillhu (1992): the SC invalidated paragraph 7's
- Defection has no automatic effect — needs a complaint; member gets a hearing.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.